from rebirth (***moksha***). They prevent the influx of fresh ***karma*** and destroy ***karmic*** residues. Release is the manifestation of the soul's true nature as omniscient and so on once defects such as passionate attachments (*raga*) have ceased.

Karma is a sort of material substance that adheres to the soul. Souls are conditioned by morally good and bad *karmic* influxes (*asrava*) that impede their innate powers and tie them to particular sequences of embodied experiences. ***Karma*** and embodiment can only be burnt off by religious practices.

There are eight forms of ***karma***: four harmful and four not harmful. The worst sort is deluding ***karma***, which causes attachment to false beliefs and the incapacity to lead a religiously virtuous life. It has to be eliminated first. Other harmful varieties prevent the efficient functioning of the intellect and senses, and suppression of the soul's natural omniscience. The positive sorts condition possible types of experience as pleasant or otherwise, how one is reborn, the length of one's life and one's status in a species.

See ***anekanta-vada***

Further reading: Balcerowicz 2000; Dundas 1992; Ganeri 2001a; Halbfass 1992; Jaini 1979 and 2000

Jaina ethics: *Jaina* monks and nuns, who have no possessions beyond the most basic necessities, vow to abstain from harming living creatures (***ahimsa***), lying, theft, sexual malpractice and attachment to worldly objects. They eat only vegetarian food prepared specially for them and there is a stress on fasting. Soul and matter are closely associated, so any type of action has moral as well as physical effects.

The laity's vows include non-injury, truthfulness and honesty in commercial dealings and charity to the monastic order. They are committed to honest ways of acquiring